

The Ashtavakra Gita

→ and the ←
Path of Self-Realisation



SAKSHI PATEL

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THE ASHTAVAKRA GITA AND THE PATH OF SELF- REALISATION



You are not the body. You are the pure, eternal Self.

The Dialogue of Sage Ashtavakra and King Janaka

Based on the Divine Teachings of
BAPUJI DASHRATHBHAI PATEL

Founder, Paramshanti Ashram
Vishwa Parivartak Ishwariya Vidhyalay

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About Bapuji



Bapuji (full name: Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel, also lovingly called “Dadaji” by the younger generation) was born in 1956 in the small village of Akhaj in the Mehsana district of Gujarat. However, he spent his childhood in another village named Ambasan, also located in the Mehsana district.

In the early part of his life, he was a highly successful lawyer. Later, he devoted his life to realizing the supreme spiritual truth and bringing this divine knowledge forward for the welfare of humanity. Today, this supreme knowledge serves as a guiding light for true seekers to realize their ultimate destiny. It is a blessing of the highest divinity that the present time is witnessing the rise of this supreme spiritual knowledge, guiding souls on Earth to return to their original source.

Despite being raised in a very poor family and facing challenging circumstances, Bapuji had a deep desire to transform this sorrowful and suffering world into a better place. At the young age of six, he questioned God repeatedly, asking why God remained silent about the suffering of humanity. This intense longing to end human suffering eventually led him to attain the highest level of spirituality later in life.

Even as a child, Bapuji would spend hours alone in the fields, often neglecting his own comfort. Due to poverty, he would walk barefoot without shoes or sandals, frequently getting pricked by thorns. Many times, he would stay late in the fields and, on his way back home, encounter subtle world entities. These experiences sparked his interest in communicating with subtle world souls.

Bapuji was courageous from a young age, which helped him overcome many obstacles. Alongside his studies in chartered accountancy (CA), he gave tuition classes to support himself financially. Later, he completed his Bachelor of Law (LLB) degree and became a well-known lawyer in Ahmedabad.

In 1997, he established a spiritual institution called “Vishwa Parivartak Ishwariya Vidhyalay” in Chenpur, Ahmedabad, with the mission of transforming this mortal world, filled with suffering and disorder, into an eternal divine world of immortality. Smt. Sushma Tandon, lovingly known as “Maa,” worked alongside Bapuji in this grand divine mission.

To accomplish this mission, Bapuji worked tirelessly, dedicating all his resources to this divine purpose. During that time, he would deliver continuous spiritual

discourses for up to 18 hours without rest. In these discourses, he explained the highest dimensions of divine knowledge, which he realized through deep meditation and divine vision in a state of superconsciousness. This knowledge goes beyond the imagination of the ordinary human mind.

Bapuji's teachings cover a vast range of topics, including the types of celestial creators across different dimensions, the creation of our solar system, galaxy, and universe, and most importantly, the transcendental knowledge of the multiverse and realities beyond it. His knowledge is supremely profound and is intended for highly evolved seekers, referred to as "behad souls." According to Bapuji, these "behad souls" will play a key role in transforming this mortal world into an eternal divine realm.

At present, Bapuji remains deeply engaged in intense meditation and samadhi for long hours. He does not meet anyone, as he is continuously immersed in his transcendental mission in a superconscious state.

About Smt. Sakshi Patel



Smt. Sakshi Patel is a spiritual guide, meditation teacher, and a dedicated contributor to the global mission of spreading divine knowledge as taught by Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel. Along with Shri. Anant Patel, she has played a key role in expanding these teachings to a global audience, helping grow the YouTube channel Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel to over 16 million subscribers, making it one of the most widely followed spiritual platforms. Through her calm presence and clear expression, she has become a guiding force for seekers who wish to understand and experience inner transformation.

She is widely known for her work on the YouTube channel “Paramshanti Motivation & Meditation,” which has over 6 lakh+ subscribers, where she conducts daily guided meditation sessions in the morning and shares deep spiritual insights in a simple, practical, and experienceable manner, bridging profound spiritual wisdom with modern life.

With over 1000+ live meditation sessions completed, she has consistently guided thousands of seekers toward inner awareness and stability. With MBA (Finance) education, Smt. Sakshi Patel chose to dedicate herself fully to the path of spiritual service. Her journey reflects a shift from external success to inner realization, aligning completely with the teachings of self-awareness, consciousness, and Paramshanti.

Her words are not merely motivational—they are rooted in direct understanding and are designed to awaken deeper awareness within the reader. The Ashtavakra Gita discourses gathered in this book grew out of her daily morning sessions, in which the Gita was read verse by verse and then experienced in meditation.

Contents



Preface

Chapter One The Direct Path of Non-Duality

Chapter Two You Are Not A Body-You Are Pure-Self

Chapter Three Three Great Questions

Chapter Four Silence of the Mind

Chapter Five As the Vision, So is the World

Chapter Six Liberation While Living

Chapter Seven The Threefold Practise & Grace of Guru

Chapter Eight Birth and Wisdom of Sage Ashtavakra

Chapter Nine Knowledge Begins Where Pride Ends

Chapter Ten The Dream and The Waking- What Is Real?

Chapter Eleven Pure-Self , As Sky and As Ocean

Chapter Twelve Freedom Within

Chapter Thirteen Dispassion Born of Knowledge

Chapter Fourteen The Nature of the Realized Sage

Chapter Fifteen The Ignorant and the Wise

Chapter Sixteen Practice of Paramshanti Meditation

Chapter Seventeen Knowledge and Yog Together

Chapter Eighteen Path of Self- realisation and Liberation

Sakshi Patel Insights

Glossary

Video Sources

Upcoming Film

Connect With Us

Preface



Gyan Daan Maha Daan

(Sharing Knowledge is the Highest Charity)

Share to the maximum extent with all.

— by *Bapuji Dashrathbbhai Patel*

The Ashtavakra Gita is a conversation between a realized sage and a king who wished, above everything else, to know the truth of his own Self. In a few clear words it sets down the highest vision of Advaita Vedanta: that you are not the body, not the mind, not the endless play of the world, but the pure awareness in which all of this appears and passes away.

The pages that follow grew from daily practice. Each morning, the Ashtavakra Gita was read slowly, verse by verse, in the light of the teachings of Bapuji Dashrathbbhai Patel, and then carried into meditation. What is offered here is not a commentary written from the outside, but the fruit of that quiet, repeated listening — refined into simple English so that any sincere seeker may walk the same path.

This book asks only one thing of you: read it slowly. Let each idea settle before moving to the next. The Self that these words point to is not far away; it is the very awareness with which you are reading now. May these pages help you remember who you have always been, and may that remembrance ripen into the supreme peace — Paramshanti — that is your own true nature.

CHAPTER ONE



The Direct Path of Non-Duality

Ashtavakra Gita is one of the purest and most direct scriptures of Advaita Vedanta — the vision of non-duality, in which the Self alone is real and everything else is only an appearance. Among all the great texts of Sanatan wisdom, it stands apart because it does not begin gently. It begins at the summit. Most scriptures take the seeker by the hand and lead them slowly upward, step by step, from devotion to discipline to knowledge. Ashtavakra Gita assumes that the seeker is already standing at the door of the highest truth and is simply waiting to be told who they really are.

This is why it is good to compare it, for a moment, with Bhagavad Gita. The Bhagavad Gita opens on a battlefield. Arjuna is overcome by sorrow, confusion, and attachment. He cannot act, he cannot think clearly, and so the teaching begins by lifting him out of his grief. Ashtavakra Gita opens very differently. There is no breakdown, no despair. King Janaka comes to the sage with a direct and burning hunger for self-knowledge, for liberation, and for *vairagya* — dispassion. He does not ask how to win a war. He asks how to know the Self.

This scripture carries a message of higher wisdom and clear understanding. It reminds the soul that the worldly things it constantly pursues cannot provide lasting fulfilment or true peace.

All This Is Futile and False

The teaching begins with a doorway with only one single recognition: *yah sab vyarth aur mithya hai* — all this is futile and false. This is not despair, and it is not a rejection of life. It is a precise spiritual statement. The word *mithya* does not mean that the world does not exist. It means that the world appears real but is not the ultimate truth. It is real enough to be lived in, yet not real enough to rest upon for eternity.

To understand *mithya* (the temporary or apparent reality), it helps to see three levels of experience. First is the everyday world, where we live, work, eat, and interact with others. Second is the dream world, which feels completely real while we are dreaming but disappears as soon as we wake up. Third is the absolute reality—the eternal truth that never changes, never comes into existence, and never ceases to exist. The worlds of waking and dreaming are both temporary and

changing. The true Self, however, belongs to the absolute reality. It remains constant through all experiences, untouched by the rise and fall of the worlds we perceive through the senses.

Worldly identity is therefore temporary and spiritual identity is eternal. Whatever you can lose was never finally yours. The body changes, the name changes, the roles change, the relationships change. Only one thing remains the same through childhood, youth and old age, through waking and dream and deep sleep -awareness that knows all of it. That awareness is the Self.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ *“Yah sab vyarth aur mithya hai.”*

“All this is futile and false — only the Self is real.”

Knowing the Imperishable

The whole purpose of spiritual life is to stop being lost in the perishable and to become aware of imperishable. Upanishads, whole of Vedanta and Ashtavakra Gita all point in one direction, again and again. They turn us toward *avinashi* — that which cannot be destroyed — and toward *param satya*, the supreme truth.

There is an order to this knowledge. First one becomes a *tattva-jnani* — a knower of the Self, one who has understood the elements of existence and seen through them to the conscious being within. Then, in time, one becomes a *brahma-jnani* — a knower of Brahman, the boundless reality in which the whole of creation appears. Every scripture, every Upanishad, is gently carrying us along this same road: from the limited toward the limitless, from the form toward the formless, from the seen toward the seer.

This is the spirit in which Ashtavakra Gita should be received. It is not rule book. It is a mirror held up to the soul, in which the soul is invited, at last, to recognize its own eternal face.

CHAPTER TWO



You Are Not A Body --You Are Pure Self

The first and most repeated teaching of this scripture is so simple that the mind almost refuses to take it seriously: you are not body; you are Soul. *Tu shareer nahi, tu atma hai*. Sage does not say this once. He returns to it repeatedly, because all our suffering grows from forgetting this one fundamental truth.

Body, mind, intellect, ego and the senses are not the real “I.” They are instruments. Body is the vehicle; the senses are its doors; the mind gathers impressions; the intellect decides; the ego says “this is me.” But none of these is the one who is aware of them all. The one who watches the body, who watches the mind think, who watches the senses reach out — that witness is the Self / Soul.

The Nature of Pure Self

What is this **Pure-Self**? It is pure consciousness. It is the awareness in which all things are known. The Self is light, awareness, peace and power. It is *aja* — unborn; it is deathless, changeless, and beyond every limitation. It was never born and will never die. Birth and death belong to the body, not to the one who wears it.

Because the Self is beyond the body, it is untouched by disease, sorrow, pleasure, pain, birth, and death. These pass across it the way clouds pass across the sky, while the sky itself remains unmarked. **Pure-Self** is silent-witness (*sakshi*) of body, the mind, the senses and the world. It sees, but it is not changed by what it sees. This is the great difference between the body-conscious person and the Self-aware person. The body-conscious person believes, “I am this flesh; what happens to it happens to me.” The Self-aware person knows, “I am the awareness; the body comes and goes within me.” The same events fall upon both, but one is crushed by them and the other remains free.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ “*Tu shareer nahi, tu atma hai.*”

“*You are not the body; you are the Self.*”

The Many Illusions of “I”

Our bondage is built from a series of mistaken identifications. There is the illusion of identifying with the physical body-believing that its beauty, its strength, and its decay are our own. There is the illusion of identifying with the mind and the emotions-believing that we are our anger, our fear, our moods. And there is the illusion of identifying with social roles and relationships-believing that we are the position we hold, the titles we carry, the family we belong to. From all of these grows the deepest illusion of all: the sense of “I” and “mine.” Once this takes root, bondage follows on its own. The thought “I am the doer” binds us, for it makes us anxious about every result. The thought “this is mine” binds us, for it makes us tremble at every loss. And from these come attachment to family, wealth, position, body and reputation- the heavy chains that the soul drags from life to life.

Ashtavakra Gita does not ask us to throw these things away. It asks us to see them clearly. When we know that this body is not Pure-Self yet body can be cared for, however it no longer rules us. When we know that nothing is finally “mine,” we can still hold things lightly, but they no longer hold us. To know “I am the Self” is to set down, quietly, a weight we have carried so long that we mistook it for ourselves.

CHAPTER THREE



Three Great Questions

When King Janaka sat before the sage, he did not ask many things. He asked three. And these three questions are the foundation upon which the entire Ashtavakra Gita is built. They are also, in truth, the three deepest questions of every spiritual seeker in every age.

He asked: How is knowledge attained? How is liberation attained? And how does dispassion arise? In these three lies the whole of the path. Knowledge removes ignorance; liberation removes bondage; dispassion removes of the world. Where these three are complete, nothing more remains to be sought.

These are not the questions of a restless mind looking for novelty. They are the questions of a soul that has tasted the emptiness of everything else and now wants only the truth. Every sincere seeker, sooner or later, arrives at exactly these three.

Becoming Worthy of Knowledge

Yet the sage does not answer instantly, because there is something that must come first. One must become worthy of receiving Self-knowledge. This is not a matter of cleverness or learning. It is a matter of inner readiness.

Knowledge does not stay in an impure mind. You may hear it, repeat it, even teach it — and still it will slip away, because the ground is not prepared to hold it. Ego, above all, prevents spiritual knowledge from entering deeply. Where even a trace of *ahankara* — the pride of “I am this body, this position, this status” — remains, the supreme knowledge cannot settle in the soul.

A restless mind, too, cannot hold the truth. Truth is subtle and silent; a mind that is forever agitated cannot receive it any more than a shaking vessel can hold still water. An uncontrolled mind, in fact, becomes the very cause of bondage, for it runs after every desire and binds the soul to each one.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Abankaar chhodo aur mann ko apni mutthi mein rakho.”***
“Leave the ego, and hold the mind in your fist.”

This is why the teaching gives a clear instruction at the threshold: leave the ego, and hold the mind in your fist. The seeker who can do even this much has prepared the soil. Into such a prepared soil, the seed of Self-knowledge falls and takes root at once. The three great questions can only be truly answered in one who has first become quiet enough, and humble enough, to hear.

CHAPTER FOUR



Silence of the Mind

If the mind must be held in the fist before knowledge can enter, then we must speak honestly about how difficult that is. Controlling the mind is among the hardest things a human being can attempt. The mind wanders, argues, remembers, fears, and desires, often all at once. And yet mastery of the mind must come before higher knowledge can be received and held.

There is an old and important truth here: Mind is the cause of both victory and defeat. When the mind is controlled, it becomes the finest friend a seeker can have—steady, clear and obedient. When it is uncontrolled, it becomes the worst enemy, dragging the soul again and again into agitation and bondage. The same instrument can lift us to liberation or chain us to suffering; everything depends on whether we are its master or its servant.

Beyond Mind, Into Silence

We must be careful, though, not to confuse two very different things: suppressing the mind and going beyond the mind. To suppress is to force the mind down by struggle, which only stores up pressure. To go beyond is to rise above the mind, the intellect, and the senses, into a state where their noise no longer reaches us. The goal is not a beaten mind, but a quiet one. This quietness of mind has a name in this teaching: *aman* — the state beyond mental disturbance, the mind that has become so still it is almost as if there were no mind at all. It is the silence beyond verbal silence. A person may sit with closed lips and still be roaring inside; that is outer silence only. *Aman* is inner silence — the silence of the mind itself. And this mental silence is the first doorway into deep yog. Until the mind grows quiet, meditation cannot truly begin.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Mann ko jeet ke raja ban — mann ka gulam mat ban.”***

“Become a king by conquering the mind — do not become its slave.”

Steady Amid Everything

How is such steadiness practised? How do we develop this inner stability? Not by avoiding the world, but by learning to experience it without losing our peace. We continue to see, hear, and interact with life, yet we do not allow external events to disturb our inner calm.

With practice, we become able to remain peaceful whether people praise us or criticize us, and whether circumstances are favourable or difficult. This is not indifference—it is true freedom. A seeker's real test comes during challenging times. When life is comfortable, staying calm is easy. But when difficulties arise, our inner state is revealed. Adverse situations show us how much peace, strength, and stability we have truly developed within. When under pressure, subtle ego immediately appears. A small remark, an unexpected difficulty and at once anger, jealousy, irritation, and reaction rise to the surface. These reactions are not failures to be ashamed of; they are messengers. They reveal the hidden impurities that are still within us. This is why a seeker must check and change himself daily — quietly observing what arises and gently correcting it. There is a world of difference between outer spiritual display and inner transformation. One can speak beautifully of the Self and still be ruled by reaction. The serious seeker, therefore, turns the attention inward. The work is self-analysis, not judging others. When the mind has been mastered in this way, it no longer stands between the soul and the truth.

CHAPTER FIVE



As the Vision, So is the World

There is a principle in this teaching that quietly explains why two people can look at the same world and see two entirely different things. It runs like this: as the inner tendency, so the vision; as the vision, so the world. *Jaisi vritti, vaisi drishti; jaisi drishti, vaisi srishhti*. What we carry within us decides how we see, and how we see decides the world we experience.

This is why inner purity matters so much. A mind coloured by *rajasic* restlessness and *tamasic* darkness cannot see clearly; these tendencies disturb spiritual progress at every step, distorting both perception and judgement. If there is anger in us, we see a hostile world. If there is craving, we see only objects to be seized. The world we meet is, in large part, the reflection of the tendencies we bring to it.

Cleansing the Inner Vision

Then the work is to become free from attachment, aversion, jealousy, anger, pride, greed and hatred — the inner colours that stain the vision. In their place, the seeker cultivates compassion, patience, tolerance, steadiness, and spiritual maturity. As these grow, the same world begins to look entirely different: softer, clearer, and no longer threatening.

The great souls show us how far this goes. They have tolerated insult while continuing to give truth to the world. To be reviled and yet to respond with knowledge and goodwill requires an enormous inner strength — a strength that only a purified soul possesses. This is the meaning of true humility in spiritual life: not weakness, but a vastness so secure that no insult can shake it.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Jaisi vritti, vaisi drishti; jaisi drishti, vaisi srishhti.”***

“As the inner tendency, so the vision; as the vision, so the world.”

The Subtle Trap of Spiritual Pride

Now comes a warning that every sincere seeker must hear, for it is the most easily missed. There is great danger in being proud of having higher knowledge, and an equal danger in being proud of being spiritually fortunate. The thought, “I am blessed; I have received the supreme knowledge; I am one of the fortunate souls,” is sweet — and precisely because it is sweet, it hides a subtle ego.

This is the danger of subtle ego among spiritual seekers. It does not look like ordinary pride. It wears the robes of devotion and knowledge, and so it slips past our guard. A worldly person may at least know their pride; a seeker may not even notice it. This is why even a knowledgeable seeker must remain alert. The higher one climbs, the more quietly ego learns to follow. To keep watch over this subtle pride, every single day, is itself a mark of true wisdom.

CHAPTER SIX



Liberation While Living

One of the most liberating truths in this entire scripture is that freedom is not something to be reached only after death, in some distant world. It is *jivanmukti* — liberation while living, freedom enjoyed here and now, while still in the body. The soul does not have to wait. It can be free in the very midst of life.

To understand this, we must separate two things that are often confused: outer renunciation and inner liberation. A person may leave home, give up possessions, and wear the robes of a renunciate, and still carry the whole world inside their mind. Another may live in a family, perform every duty, and yet be inwardly free. True freedom is inner. It is the difference between physical action and inner non-doership-between the hands that work and the soul that remains untouched.

Why Action Does Not Bind the Self

Here lies a teaching of great subtlety: action does not bind the Self; attachment to action binds the mind. The Self is never the doer. It is the body and the senses that act, while the Self simply witnesses. What creates bondage is not the action itself, but the inner clinging — the “I am doing this, this result must be mine.”

This is how a realized person acts without being attached to action. Such a one performs every worldly duty without inner bondage — working fully, yet owning nothing, expecting nothing, and remaining serene whether the result is success or failure. There is all the difference in the world between *karma* performed with desire and action performed in freedom. The first sows seeds that must be reaped; the second leaves no seed at all.

Action done without desire has another gift: *nishkama karma* — selfless, desireless action — is a purifier of the mind. When we act without grasping at the fruit, the mind slowly grows clean and quiet, until it becomes fit to receive the highest knowledge.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ “*Karm shareer karta hai — atma to sirf saakshi hai.*”

“The body performs action; the Self is only the witness.”

Poison and Nectar

The scripture is direct about what stands in the way. Desire is called a great enemy of knowledge, for it keeps the mind running outward, away from the Self. And sensory pleasures are compared to poison — sweet at the first taste, but binding and exhausting in their effect, leaving the soul more restless than before.

Against these, the teaching holds up what is truly nourishing. Forgiveness, simplicity, compassion, contentment, and truth are compared to nectar. These do not bind; they free. They do not agitate; they settle the soul into peace. The one who tastes this nectar, even while living an ordinary life, has already begun to taste liberation.

CHAPTER SEVEN



The Threefold Practise and Grace of Guru

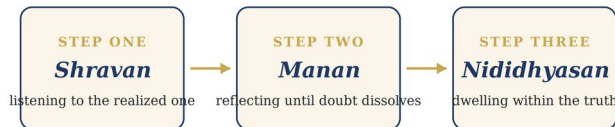
We have said that one must become worthy before knowledge can enter. But what is this worthiness, and how is it earned? The scripture answers with a clear and ancient method. True eligibility for Brahma-knowledge is not won by birth or cleverness. It is ripened through a threefold practice that turns heard words into lived reality.

For there is a vast difference between hearing knowledge and becoming knowledge-form — between listening to a teaching and becoming the very embodiment of it. To merely hear is to hold an idea in the mind. To become knowledge-form is for that truth to shine from one's whole being. The bridge between the two is repeated listening, reflection, meditation, and assimilation.

The Threefold Practice

This bridge has three stages, named in the tradition with great precision. The first is *shravan* — listening to the words of the realized one, hearing the truth spoken by someone who has actually realized it. The second is *manan* — reflecting deeply on the teaching, turning it over in the intellect until every doubt dissolves. The third is *nididhyasan* — living in continuous awareness of the truth, until it is no longer a thought one has, but the very ground one stands on.

THE THREEFOLD PRACTICE



"Listen, reflect deeply, and then dwell continually within the truth."

Of these, the first carries a quiet power that should not be underestimated. Hearing the words of a realized teacher can awaken Self-awareness directly. When truth is spoken by one who lives it, the words carry a vibration that the written page cannot fully hold, and that vibration stirs something in the listener that mere reading rarely touches.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ *“Sun-na, manan karna, aur usi mein nivaas karna.”*

“Listen, reflect deeply, and then dwell continually within the truth.”

The One Who Destroys the Ego

This is why the Guru holds so central a place in the Ashtavakra Gita. The greatness of a true Guru is that he gives direct Self-knowledge — not borrowed belief, not second-hand opinion, but the living recognition of who one truly is.

And here is the mark by which a true Guru may be known: a true Guru destroys ego rather than feeding personality. A false teacher leaves the disciple more inflated than before, more attached to being special. A true teacher quietly dismantles the very “I” that seeks to be special, until only the Self remains.

Consider King Janaka. He was a wise king, a ruler, a man of learning and discernment. And yet he needed Ashtavakra. Why? Because no amount of worldly wisdom can, by itself, reveal the Self. The final recognition comes through the grace of one who has already seen. Even the wisest seeker bows here — not to a personality, but to the truth that the Guru carries and is willing to hand on.

CHAPTER EIGHT



Birth and Wisdom of Sage Ashtavakra

To understand why this scripture sees so clearly through the body to the soul, it helps to know the story of the sage from whom it takes its name. The very life of Ashtavakra is a teaching in itself.

While Ashtavakra was still in his mother's womb, his father, a learned scholar, was reciting the scriptures aloud. From within the womb, the unborn child perceived an error in the recitation. When the child pointed this out, the father, in a moment of anger, pronounced a curse — and so the child was born with eight bends, eight deformities in his body. From these eight bends comes the name *Ashtavakra*: “eight-bent.”

The Bent Body and the Straight Vision

Here is the symbol the whole story turns upon: the body was bent in eight places, but the vision of the soul within was perfectly straight. Outwardly, the form was crooked and unlovely; inwardly, the wisdom was flawless and pure. This is the great contrast between outer deformity and inner wisdom — and it carries a warning we forget at our peril: there is real danger in judging a realized being by the body. The vessel may be plain, even broken, while the treasure within is beyond price.

This truth was put to the test in the most public way. When Ashtavakra entered King Janaka's assembly, the assembled scholars looked at his bent limbs and laughed. They saw only the crooked body and not the towering wisdom that had come among them.

Ashtavakra's response is one of the most piercing moments in all of Sanatan literature. He called the assembly foolish — not in cruelty, but in correction — because they saw only the body. He taught them, in effect, that one who sees only skin, flesh, and bones is not truly wise, however learned he may be. Here lies the whole difference between learned scholarship and true wisdom — the difference between the *pandit*, who has memorised much, and the *tattva-jnani*, who has actually seen the truth. Many know the words; few know the Self.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Jo keval charm, maans aur haddi dekhta hai, woh gyani nahi.”***

“One who sees only skin, flesh, and bone is not truly wise.”

The Debate That Freed the Captives

There is a second great incident in this assembly. A scholar named Bandi sat there, undefeated in debate, and connected with Varuna, the lord of the waters. The condition of his contests was severe: the scholar who lost the debate had to take water-samadhi — to be given over to the waters. By this means, many learned Brahmins were being sent to Varuna-loka, the realm of Varuna. Among those who had lost to Bandi and been sent to that realm was Ashtavakra's own father. And so the young sage came with a resolve burning in his heart — to free his father and the imprisoned Brahmins. He entered the debate, and through the sheer force of his wisdom he defeated Bandi and broke his pride. With that defeat, the captive Brahmins returned from Varuna-loka. An entire community of learned souls was set free through the wisdom of one bent-bodied sage.

The spiritual meaning is unmistakable: pride is defeated through wisdom, and wisdom liberates. The crooked body that the scholars had laughed at became the very instrument of their deliverance. So it is with the Self — plain and unnoticed by the proud, yet the source of all true freedom.

CHAPTER NINE



Knowledge Begins Where Pride Ends

There is a third incident in life of King Janaka that strikes at the most subtle pride of all — the pride of seeker who believes that the highest truth can be seized in an instant, like any other prize.

King Janaka had read in the scriptures that Self-knowledge can be received in a very short time. From this he formed a proud conclusion. He summoned the learned scholars of his kingdom and challenged them: whoever could give him Self-knowledge in an instant would be richly rewarded — and whoever failed would be imprisoned. So it happened that scholars who could not give him instant Self-knowledge were thrown into his prison.

In the Time It Takes to Mount a Horse

When Sage Ashtavakra came to know of this, he set about challenging Janaka's pride and set things right in his kingdom. Janaka demanded knowledge on Soul in the shortest time taken. Time taken should be same as time taken to mount a horse — one foot in the stirrup, and before the other touched the saddle, he wished to be enlightened.

Now, there is a true and beautiful meaning hidden in this idea of “instant enlightenment.” For a soul that is fully ready, recognition can indeed dawn in a single moment. But readiness is everything. The lightning is instant; yet the sky must first be clear. And so Ashtavakra told Janaka the truth that his pride had hidden from him: knowledge requires eligibility. The flash of recognition is quick, but the long preparation of the soul is not.

To show this, the sage gave an image that has never been forgotten: a mountain peak cannot hold rainwater. The rain may fall in torrents, but the proud peak sheds it all and stays dry, while the low valley fills and grows green. So too, an egoistic mind cannot hold knowledge. However freely the truth is poured, the proud mind lets it run off and remains barren. Only the humble, lowered mind retains what is given.

✦ ***“Pahaad ki choti par paani nahi tikta — ahankaari mann mein gyan nahi tikta.”***

“Water does not stay on a mountain peak — knowledge does not stay in an egoistic mind.”

Hearing this, Janaka was humbled. He realized his mistake, saw the pride that had driven him to imprison the learned sages, and released the imprisoned Brahmins. The king who had demanded knowledge as a right now understood it as a grace — to be received by a soul made ready, made humble, and made still.

CHAPTER TEN



The Dream and the Waking — What Is Real?

Of all the incidents in Janaka's awakening, none is more profound than the one that began in his sleep. One night, king dreamed that he had become a beggar, destitute, hungry, wandering and begging even for a little food. The misery of it was complete and utterly convincing. Then he awoke, and there he was again, a king upon his bed.

But the dream had shaken something loose in him, and he could not rest. After waking, a deep confusion seized the king, and he gathered his court to ask a single, burning question: which is real — the dream state or the waking state? In the dream, he had truly felt himself a beggar. Awake, he truly felt himself a king. Which of these was true? Or were both, in some way, false?

Both Are Appearances

The answer Ashtavakra gives is the heart of non-dual wisdom: both dream and waking are appearances. Neither is the final reality. The dream state is a symbol of imagination, projection, and inner illusion — a world spun entirely from the mind, which felt absolutely real until it ended. And here is the teaching that turns everything over: the waking state, too, is another form of dream when it is lived in ignorance.

This is the deeper meaning of the saying that life itself is like a dream until Self-realization. Why does waking reality feel so solid and real? Only because of identification — because we have invested ourselves in it, just as the dreamer was wholly invested in the dream. The moment identification ends, the spell is broken. This is why spiritual awakening is the real awakening: it is the waking from the dream of the waking world itself.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Jab tak aatma ka bodh nahi, tab tak yah jeevan bhi ek sapna hai.”***

“Until the Self is realized, even this waking life is only a dream.”

The Witness of All States

To see this clearly, the teaching points to the three states through which every human being passes: waking, dream and deep sleep. In waking we meet the outer world; in dream we meet a world of mind; in deep sleep we meet nothing at all, and yet we exist. Something passes through all three and is changed by none of them.

That something is the witness that remains beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep. It is the Self, the knower of all states. The Self knows the waking, knows the dream, knows the deep sleep — and is not itself any of them. Therefore the Self is not affected by what appears in any state. The beggar of the dream and the king of the waking are both pictures passing before the same unchanging awareness.

THE THREE STATES & THE WITNESS



Something passes through all three and is changed by none of them.

How Illusion Ends

What gives these appearances their seeming reality is illusion (*maya*) and illusion is products of ignorance. They are not destroyed by force or by ritual alone. *Maya* is removed by knowledge, not merely by external rituals. The role of knowledge is to end illusion itself; only knowledge can lift the veil. And the role of meditation is to stabilize the purified mind, so that what knowledge reveals does not slip away. This is why knowledge is held to be superior to every object and every worldly gain. Wealth, power, pleasure, even heaven — all are within the dream. Knowledge alone wakes us from it. There is nothing one can acquire in any state that compares to the one thing that ends the spell of all states.

CHAPTER ELEVEN



Pure- Self, As Sky and As Ocean

Having shown that the world is an appearance, the scripture now gives the seeker a set of luminous images, so that the mind can rest in the truth rather than merely think about it. Each image points to the same recognition: that the world is a projection upon the Self, and the Self itself remains untouched.

Picture the world as appearing in consciousness like waves in the ocean. The Self is the ocean, and the world is the waves. The waves rise and fall, foam and vanish, but the ocean is neither increased by their rising nor diminished by their falling. The whole universe arises in you as bubbles arise from the sea.

THE SELF AND THE WORLD

universes rise and dissolve, like bubbles



"Tujhe vishwa is prakar utpann hota hai, jaise samudra se bulbule."

The whole universe rises within you, as bubbles rise from the sea.

Or picture the Self as space and the world as clouds or objects appearing in space. The clouds drift, gather, and disperse, but the sky is never stained by them and never moved. Or picture the Self as a crystal, and the world as the colours reflected within it — the crystal takes on every hue, yet remains in itself perfectly clear. In all these images the meaning is one: the Self is the support of all appearances without being changed by them.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Tujhe vishwa is prakar utpann hota hai, jaise samudra se bulbule.”***

“The whole universe rises within you, as bubbles rise from the ocean.”

The Great Affirmations

From these images flow the great affirmations of the realized soul. “I am like the infinite sky.” “I am like the shoreless ocean.” “The world rises and dissolves in me.” “I am all, yet untouched by all.” “I am pure, stainless, and beyond imagination.” These are not boasts; they are the natural speech of awareness that has recognized its own vastness.

Beyond Every Pair of Opposites

To understand the Self, it is often easier to understand what it is not. The Self cannot be defined by anything in the world because it exists beyond everything it observes. It is beyond the five elements that make up all physical forms and beyond the three gunas—purity, activity, and inertia—that influence nature and the mind.

The Self is also beyond ideas of virtue and vice, merit and sin, because these belong to human actions and experiences. It is beyond the senses of sight, sound, touch, taste, and smell, for it is the awareness that knows these experiences, not an object that can be experienced by them.

Likewise, the Self is beyond time, space, cause and effect, birth and death, pleasure and pain, gain and loss. All the opposites by which we measure life belong to the changing world. The Self remains untouched by them. When all that is temporary and changing is set aside, what remains is the eternal witness—our true nature, which can be realized only through direct inner experience.

CHAPTER TWELVE



Freedom Within

There is a quality of the realized soul that the scripture returns to with great tenderness: *nisanga*, an absolute non-attachment, a freedom so complete that the soul leans on nothing and needs nothing outside itself. The Self does not need company. It is whole in itself, lacking nothing, seeking nothing.

This must be carefully distinguished from loneliness. Loneliness is the ache of an incomplete self-reaching outward for what it lacks. Self-abidance is the fullness of a complete being resting in what it is. The two may look alike from outside — both are alone — but inwardly they are opposite. One is empty and aching; the other is full and at peace.

Atmarama and Manorama

The teaching gives two beautiful words for where the soul may rest. One is *Atmarama* — one who rests in the Self, who finds joy in the Self alone. The other is *Manorama* — one who rests in the mind, who seeks delight in the mind's restless movement and its objects. The difference between them decides everything.

For resting in the mind creates bondage. The mind is forever moving, forever wanting; to rest there is to be carried along by every wave of desire and fear. But resting in the Self creates freedom. The Self is still, complete, and unchanging; to rest there is to be at peace whatever the mind and the world may do.

And so the great instruction of this scripture can be spoken plainly: the body is not yours, and you are not the body; you are not the doer and not the enjoyer; you are the eternal witness-consciousness. Knowing this, remain independent and move through life in happiness. being inwardly free, walk through the world in joy.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ *“Atma mein vishraam kar, aur swatantra ho kar anand mein vichar.”*

“Rest in the Self, and being inwardly free, move through life in joy.”

Sovereignty Within

This freedom is what the scripture means by inner independence and spiritual sovereignty. There is a vast difference between worldly power and Self-power. Worldly power rules outer things and is itself ruled by fear of losing them. Self-power rules nothing outside and therefore fears nothing — it is the only true sovereignty, the kingship of a soul that owns itself.

King Janaka is the living proof of this. He was a king who became inwardly free while still ruling — governing a kingdom, performing every duty, and yet untouched within. His life answers a question many seekers carry: is it possible to be liberated while still living in society? The answer is yes. There is full spiritual freedom available even for householders. The Ashtavakra Gita does not teach escapism; it teaches inner detachment. There is all the difference in the world between running away from the world and seeing the world as *mithya*. One flees the world in fear; the other sees through it in wisdom and remains free wherever it stands.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN



Dispassion Born of Knowledge

King Janaka's third question was how dispassion arises. The scripture's answer overturns the common idea of renunciation entirely. Dispassion toward sensory objects is real and necessary — but it is not something to be forced. True dispassion naturally arises from knowledge. When the soul truly sees that the objects of the world are empty and passing, the craving for them falls away on its own, like a dry leaf from a branch.

This is why forced renunciation is incomplete without Self-realization. One can give up objects and still long for them inwardly; the hand lets go while the mind clings. Such renunciation is only a change of posture. True renunciation is renunciation of identification — letting go not of the object, but of the false belief that we need it to be whole.

The Many Forms of Bondage

The scripture names, with great care, the inner movements that bind us. There is the bondage created by hope and despair — the endless swing between “may it happen” and “it will not happen.” There is the bondage created by grief, fear, and desire. And there is the subtle bondage created by mental choice and rejection — by the constant inner verdict of “this should happen” and “this should not happen.”

Freedom is found in release from *sankalpa* and *vikalpa* — from the will that grasps and the doubt that wavers. It is freedom from inner conflict, and freedom from the need to control every outcome. Here the teaching offers a deep consolation: what happens may carry hidden welfare. The events we resist may be working, unseen, for our good. To trust this is to lay down an enormous burden.

The practical fruit of all this is the importance of witness-consciousness in daily life — the practice of remaining detached from invisible events and unseen forces, watching life unfold without being seized by it. The principle is simple and steady: nothing external should disturb inner peace.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Jiska is sansar mein kuch hai hi nahi, use chinta kis baat ki?”***

“For one to whom nothing in this world belongs, what is there to worry about?”

The Treasure of Supreme Peace

Why does any of this matter so much? Because the state of supreme peace is the most important spiritual treasure of all. There is a great difference between temporary happiness and Self-bliss. Worldly happiness depends on conditions and ends when they end. Self-bliss depends on nothing and therefore never ends. It is the bliss of knowing “Who am I?” — the joy of knowing one’s eternal destination and the joy of knowing the path to liberation.

From this follows a clear and bracing truth: it is not truly possible to have both Self-knowledge and constant misery at once. One who genuinely knows liberation must not remain trapped in complaint and anxiety, for the knowledge and the misery cannot coexist. Where the knowledge is real, the peace is real. And so the seeker’s daily work is to check, change, and stabilize — to notice every lower feeling, gently release it, and grow steady in peace.

Compassion Without Attachment

As this peace deepens, the soul’s relationship to all beings changes. There arises equal vision toward all and compassion toward all beings — a wide, steady goodwill that asks nothing in return. This is spiritual maturity in relationships, and it rests on a fine distinction: the difference between attachment and compassion, between love and possessiveness. Attachment binds and demands; compassion gives and frees.

In this light, even our closest bonds are seen truly. There is a quiet dissolution of body-based relationships in Self-awareness — not coldness, but clarity. The truth is that countless births have brought countless relations; across these many lives, worldly relations are temporary, formed and dissolved again and again. Attachment to relations therefore causes repeated sorrow, life after life. Kingdom, wife, son, body, and pleasures are all perishable. The contemplation of impermanence and the contemplation of death are not morbid; they are tools for dispassion, gently loosening the grip of what cannot last.

Why Desire Never Ends

Finally, the scripture exposes the deepest reason the worldly path can never satisfy: the misery of endless worldly seeking. There is an exhaustion caused by chasing objects that no achievement ever cures. For desire never ends by fulfilment. Pleasure fades the moment the desired object is obtained, and craving continues even after the achievement, simply turning toward the next thing. There is a subtle sorrow hidden inside every worldly pleasure, a quiet dissatisfaction at its very core. This is why sense-objects cannot give permanent satisfaction, and why worldly achievement cannot give final rest. Only the Self, which seeks nothing, knows rest.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN



Nature of the Realized Sage

What does it look like, from the inside, to be free? The scripture now paints the portrait of the *jivanmukta* — the one who is liberated while living. At the centre of this portrait is a profound stillness: the meaning of complete inner rest, a rest beyond duty and non-duty, beyond the very conflict of “should” and “should not.”

The realized one lives beyond the pairs of opposites that govern ordinary life. Such a one is beyond gain and loss, beyond praise and criticism, beyond honour and insult, beyond success and failure. The realized one is beyond attachment to action and inaction alike, and beyond agitation, ambition, and insecurity. The endless calculation of the mind has fallen silent — this is the soul that is beyond mental calculation.

Beyond Even the Idea of Freedom

Now the teaching reaches a height that the ordinary mind can scarcely follow. The realized one is beyond spiritual pride, and beyond even the idea “I am liberated.” For to think “I am free” is still to hold a subtle bondage — a last trace of the “I” that measures itself. In the deepest realization, this too dissolves.

And so there comes a state where bondage and liberation both lose meaning, where meditation and non-meditation both lose meaning, where knowledge and ignorance as concepts dissolve. The seeker, the seeking, and the sought all dissolve into one, and only pure awareness remains. This is not emptiness; it is fullness so complete that nothing stands apart from it to be named.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ “*Kahan bandhan, kahan moksha — jahan keval shuddh chaitanya hai.*”

“Where is bondage, where is liberation — where only pure awareness remains?”

The Conduct of the Wise

How does such a one move through the world? Here the description becomes very human and very beautiful. The nature of a wise person's conduct is to be simple, natural, effortless, and inwardly free. There is no strain in such a life, no performance. The wise person is free from anxiety about past actions and free from anxiety about future results. He is free from guilt and free from pride, free from mental agitation, and free from egoistic control. He acts, yet remains untouched while acting.

Such a one is naturally peaceful — not by effort, but by nature, for the mind has become quiet of its own accord. The wise person's inner nature is pure and luminous, with no dependence on outer objects for its happiness. Having known the Self, such a one needs no other knowledge after Self-knowledge; the search is over, for the seeker has found what was always there.

This is why the wise person's nature is rare, extraordinary, and divine. And it shows itself most of all in vision: the wise person perceives the whole world as one consciousness. Where others see a thousand separate things to grasp and fear, the realized one sees a single, seamless awareness — and within that vision, there is nothing left to fear and nothing left to grasp.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN



The Ignorant and the Wise

To help us understand the wise person, the scripture also describes the condition of the ignorant—not to criticize, but to encourage honest self-reflection. The wise see one consciousness present in all beings, while the ignorant see only separation, division, and countless objects to desire, possess, or fear.

Such a person remains identified with the body, relationships, possessions, and personal desires, living within the narrow boundaries of “I” and “mine.” Even when they hear teachings about the Self, true understanding does not arise because the mind is crowded with attachments. The words are heard, but they cannot take root.

Over time, attachment and worldly habits shape the intellect, making it difficult to recognize deeper truths. The mind becomes conditioned to seek fulfillment outside itself and overlooks what is always present within. As a result, the ignorant person remains bound—not because truth is hidden, but because attachment prevents it from being seen. Freedom begins when these attachments loosen and the mind becomes open to reality as it truly is.

Mudha and Amudha

The tradition gives two precise words for these two conditions. There is the *mudha* — the foolish one, attached to sense-objects, deluded by them and dragged along by them. And there is the *amudha* — the one who is not deluded by objects, who sees them for what they are and is not caught. The difference between them is not intelligence or learning; it is clarity of vision.

This points to the most important distinction in the whole of spiritual life: the difference between intellectual knowledge and realized knowledge — between knowing the teaching and living the teaching. One can master every word and remain wholly bound; another may hold few words and yet be free. It is the difference between spiritual curiosity and spiritual transformation, between the seeker trapped in laziness and the seeker burning for truth.

✦ ***“Sun-na alag baat hai — anubhav karna alag baat hai.”***
“To merely hear is one thing — to actually realize is another.”

The Quiet Dangers

And so the scripture warns us of the obstacles that keep the truth at arm’s length, even from those who have heard it. There is the danger of laziness in spiritual life — the slow drift of postponement. There is the danger of enjoying sense-pleasure more than Self-knowledge, choosing the smaller sweetness over the greater. There is the danger of postponing spiritual practice, always for tomorrow, and the danger of listening without practising, mistaking the hearing for the doing.

Against all of these stands one simple remedy: the need for daily spiritual discipline. The truth that is touched a little, every single day, slowly becomes one’s own. The seeker who burns quietly and steadily — who practises today, and again tomorrow, and again — crosses over, while the one who only admires the teaching is left admiring it still.

CHAPTER SIXTEEN



The Daily Practice of Paramshanti Meditation



The soul — a point of light at the brow, filling the whole being with light.

Knowledge must become living experience, and the bridge to that experience is daily practice. This is the need for daily meditation and Self-remembrance. The Ashtavakra Gita reveals who we are; meditation lets us taste it. What follows is the practice of *Paramshanti* meditation.

**Readers can read our book on-PARAMSHANTI MEDITATION.
Available in google play store for detailed method**

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN



Knowledge and Yog Together

Meditation and knowledge are not two separate paths but two wings of one flight. After meditation comes the practice of remaining in silence, and then the practice of holding the meditative state while listening to spiritual knowledge and even the practice of hearing scripture in a meditative state. To listen to the truth while still resting in stillness is to let the knowledge enter not merely the head, but the whole being.

Knowledge and yoga are inseparable, for each fulfills the other. Yoga without knowledge brings temporary calm but lacks lasting stability, while knowledge without yoga remains an intellectual concept rather than a living realization. Together, yoga steadies the mind, and knowledge illuminates the path, transforming understanding into direct experience.

Purifying the Chitta

All of this rests upon one foundation: the importance of *chitta shuddhi* for true yoga. *Chitta shuddhi* means the purification of the inner instrument — the cleansing of the deep mind where impressions are stored. Why does this matter so much? Because an impure *chitta* cannot be called truly liberated, however calm it may seem on the surface.

There are signs of an impure *chitta* — restlessness, reaction, the constant pull of desire and aversion. And there are signs of a purified *chitta* — steadiness, equal vision, an unshaken peace. To understand this we must see the relationship between mind, intellect, *chitta*, ego, and *sanskaras* — how the surface mind, the deciding intellect, the storehouse of impressions, the sense of “I,” and the seeds of past action all work together. And we must understand the relationship between *sanskaras* and distraction during meditation.

For this is why deep karmic impressions disturb concentration. When we sit to meditate, old impressions arise — yesterday’s argument, a memory from years ago, an unfinished worry — and so the mind runs toward the world during spiritual practice. This is natural; the impressions are simply surfacing to be cleansed. What is needed is the firm resolve to cross inner obstacles, and the practice of renewing one’s resolve whenever the mind wanders, gently returning, again and again, without frustration.

The Old Way of the Saints

How is the *chitta* purified? Two great means are given. *Vairagya* — dispassion — is a method of purifying the *chitta*, and *nishkama karma* — desireless action — is a method of purifying the *chitta*. There is also the old tradition of saints using simple living to purify the mind, and the purpose of *bhiksha* and humility in spiritual discipline — the deliberate cultivation of humility that wears away pride

But here we must keep a true distinction in view. There is a difference between ritual purity and inner purity, a difference between outer fasting and fasting of the mind, and a difference between outer silence and silence of the mind. The outer forms have their place, but they are only the shell. The kernel is the mind itself — its desires fasted, its noise silenced, its grasping released.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Bahar ka maun nahi — mann ka maun chahiye.”***

“Not outer silence — it is the silence of the mind that is needed.”

The First Threshold — Freedom From Worry

The first threshold of yog is mental silence, and the practical doorway to it is this: the need to stop feeding unnecessary thoughts, and the need to stop mental commentary about people and situations. So much of the mind’s noise is simply this running commentary; when we stop feeding it, much of the noise dies down on its own.

Above all there is the need to become free from worry, for worry is a major cause of sorrow. *Chinta* — worry — eats away the inner strength. The contemplation that heals it is simple: why worry for what is not truly yours? When nothing in this world is finally mine, the ground of worry falls away. And so the seeker learns freedom from stress before entering meditation, and the discipline of leaving yesterday, last year, and old memories behind before sitting down to meditate.

As these burdens fall away, a peaceful face and a gentle inner smile naturally emerge. This is not a smile created for the world to see, but one born from deep inner peace and divine joy. It is the effortless radiance of a settled soul, shining from a mind that has found rest within itself.

From Self to the World

As the *chitta* clears, the fruits appear everywhere in life, for there is a direct relationship between spiritual knowledge and emotional stability. With Self-awareness comes fearlessness, freedom from grief, freedom from expectation, freedom from jealousy, freedom from comparison, and freedom from reaction. With it comes equal vision and universal goodwill — and from these, in time, world transformation itself begins. The principle is unshakeable: self-transformation before world-transformation. One cannot give peace to the world until one has become peace; one cannot transform others until one has transformed oneself.

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN



Path of Self Realisation and Liberation

We now arrive at the summit of the entire teaching: the journey from knowing the truth to becoming it. Here the scripture asks a profound question: Who can become an instrument in divine work? Its answer is clear: only one who is free from the sense of “I” and “mine” can truly serve the divine purpose. As long as the ego remains at the centre, service is still directed toward the self. Only when the ego dissolves can one become a pure instrument of the divine plan.

This leads to the three stages of spiritual embodiment: the knowledge-form, the yoga-form, and the dharana-form. Through sustained practice of dharana, the soul’s impressions are gradually transformed and its innate divinity begins to shine forth. In time, the soul itself becomes an embodiment of knowledge. This is the true meaning of becoming the form of the Father or the divine—not merely understanding the teachings, but living them. There is a profound difference between speaking about knowledge and becoming its living proof.

The Right Attitude to Experience

At this stage of the journey, a subtle danger appears. There is great importance in not displaying spiritual experiences for the sake of the ego, and a real danger in speaking of subtle experiences with pride. The proper attitude toward spiritual experiences is humility and silence—to hold them gently, not to parade them before others.

We must also clearly distinguish between genuine inner experience and imagination, and between intellectual understanding and direct realization. There is danger in merely repeating “I am Shiva” without realization, for words spoken from the ego become a new form of pride rather than a source of freedom. The true meaning of “I am Shiva” is direct realization, not an egoistic claim. Likewise, “I am Brahman” refers to lived Self-knowledge—experienced and realized, not merely recited. This is why the Self must never be reduced to an intellectual concept, and why it is so valuable to hear the words of one who has directly realized Brahman.

The Nature of Brahman

What is this Brahman that the realized one comes to know? It is formless, stainless, and beyond all attributes. The scripture describes it through a series of luminous expressions.

It is *nirakar*—formless. It is *niranjana*—stainless. It is *nirvikar*—changeless and free from distortion. It is *nirapeksha*—independent and free from expectation. It is *nirvikalpa*—beyond all mental distinctions and alternatives. It is *shuddha*—pure. It is *shanta*—peaceful. It is *prapta-pratyaya-nivritti*—freedom from conceptual dependence and mental grasping. It is a *turiya*-like awareness, beyond the ordinary states of waking, dreaming, and deep sleep.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ **“*Main Shiv boon*” — *yah anubhav hai, abankaar ka daava nahi.*”**

“I am Shiva” is a direct realization, not a claim of the ego.”

The Inward Ascent

Now the meditation rises. There is a journey from body-awareness to subtle-awareness, to causal-awareness, and at last to Self-awareness; and within meditation, a journey from the physical world to higher *lokas*. Hold the visualization of the soul rising beyond earth’s gravity, the visualization of crossing planets, stars, galaxies, and universes, the visualization of crossing infinite cosmic realms, and the visualization of reaching the supreme realm of silence and peace.



The soul's ascent — rising beyond the world, crossing galaxies toward the realm of light.

This is the supreme realm beyond birth, death, sound, elements, sorrow, and time. It is the immortal realm, the imperishable abode, the original abode of the soul. And here is a great secret: there is a connection between knowing one's original abode and awakening divine powers. For the soul is filled with unlimited powers but covered by forgetfulness. Through Self-knowledge comes the recovery of divine powers, and so the scripture can speak of the Self-knower's extraordinary powers, and of the *alaukik* state — a state beyond ordinary worldly consciousness.

Where Is Bondage, Where Is Liberation?

The Self-realized person lives beyond all opposites—beyond right and wrong, gain and loss, desire and doubt, pleasure and pain. Such a person is free from every limitation and simply remains a witness to all thoughts and mental creations. At this stage, the questions of bondage and liberation no longer matter. As the scriptures declare: “*Where is bondage? Where is liberation? Where is joy? Where is sorrow?*” The realized one is no longer affected by the changing play of nature. This is the difference between the vision of a realized person and that of an ignorant person. The ignorant see life as divided into separate people and objects, while the realized see everything as one reality. This is the essence of non-duality (Advaita).

All beings and all worlds appear within consciousness, yet the Self remains untouched by them. Just as images appear on a screen without affecting the screen itself, the world appears in the Self but does not change the Self. Therefore, the world is a temporary appearance, while the Self alone is the ultimate reality.

The Magnet and the Iron

How can the Self act in the world and yet remain the unmoving witness? The scripture gives its most precise image: the metaphor of the magnet and the iron. The Self does not act, yet the body-mind acts in its presence — just as iron moves in the presence of a magnet, though the magnet itself does nothing. Here is the distinction between the activity of the body and the changelessness of the Self. The Self is not *kriyavan* — not the active doer; the body and senses are *kriyavan*. There is a functioning of the body in the presence of consciousness, but it is the difference between agency and witnessing presence.

THE MAGNET AND THE IRON

body & senses move in its presence



THE SELF — unmoving, does nothing

The Self does not act, yet the body acts in its presence — as iron moves before a magnet.

A realized person is free from the bondage of karma. While an ordinary person becomes attached to actions and their results, the realized one acts without ego and remains unaffected. This state is called *karma-atita*—being beyond karmic bondage. Actions continue, but they arise naturally and effortlessly, without the feeling of “I am the doer.” This is true karma-yoga in its highest form.

Such a person is free from the burden of past actions and the worry of future consequences. There is no regret about what was done and no anxiety about what was left undone. As a result, the mind becomes light, peaceful, and free. The realized soul is vast and limitless like the open sky, deep like the ocean, radiant like a flame, and luminous like the sun—both a point of light and infinite awareness.

Holding the Truth

Such a state is not held by a single insight; it must be lived and renewed. So there is the importance of daily collective meditation, the role of *satsang* in stabilizing knowledge, and the role of repetition in spiritual assimilation. There is the need to revisit important teachings repeatedly, and a sober warning: knowledge disappears from memory if it is not practised. Hence the need to bring knowledge again and again into awareness, for there is a difference between *smṛiti* — remembrance — and forgetfulness, and a need to become established in soul-conscious memory.

This matters because of a deep mechanism of the soul. There is a relationship between memory of the Self and freedom from body-conscious *sanskaras*. Body-related memories from many births keep the soul bound, and death does not end

body-conscious *sanskaras* — they travel with the soul. This is why the seeker must repeatedly practice being the Self, taking up the practice of detaching from the body, body-relations, and body-qualities. This is the meaning of becoming *videhi* — beyond body-consciousness — and of becoming a *farishta*-like being: light, detached, and above earth-consciousness. There is a clear relationship between Self-awareness and subtle ascension, between meditation and the soul's higher state.

Devotion, Surrender and the Final Goal

We should not imagine that this knowledge stands opposed to devotion. It does not. There is a place for devotion in surrendering to the Divine Presence, a place for surrender in receiving divine power, a place for love in dissolving the ego, and a place for remembrance in receiving grace. There is the experience of being seen by the Divine, the experience of receiving blessings, the experience of divine love descending drop by drop, the experience of divine power awakening hidden spiritual strength, the experience of becoming free from fear through the Divine Presence, and the experience of being purified by divine light into a new spiritual being.

Thus, in practice, we can hold together Self-knowledge and divine remembrance, Advaita and devotion. In meditation, the formless Self and the personal form of the Divine may work side by side. Yet it is important not to confuse absolute truth with devotional visualization. Visualization serves as a support for inner transformation, while knowledge serves as the final remover of ignorance. Devotion warms the heart and softens the ego; knowledge removes the last veil.

Here, at the end, the entire teaching gathers into a single aim. It is the difference between limited worldly happiness and boundless spiritual joy, between ordinary peace and supreme peace, between ordinary meditation and Self-abidance, between concentration and realization, between thought-based meditation and thought-free awareness, between visualized purity and realized purity, and between emotional devotion and liberation through knowledge.

The final goal, toward which every page has pointed, is this: to live in supreme peace, freedom, Self-awareness, and non-dual realization while still moving through life. Not after death, not in some distant world, but here and now, in the very midst of living—to know oneself as the deathless Self, untouched, complete, and forever free

Sakshi Patel Insights



A gathering of the central insights of these teachings, set down here so that the reader may return to them often. Read each one slowly, and let it settle in the heart.

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Yab sab vyarth aur mithya hai.”***

“All this is futile and false — only the Self is real.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Tu shareer nahi, tu atma hai.”***

“You are not the body; you are the Self.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Abankaar chhodo aur mann ko apni mutthi mein rakho.”***

“Leave the ego, and hold the mind in your fist.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

★ ***“Mann ko jeet ke raja ban — mann ka gulam mat ban.”***

“Become a king by conquering the mind — do not become its slave.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Jaisi vritti, vaisi drishti; jaisi drishti, vaisi srishiti.”***
“As the inner tendency, so the vision; as the vision, so the world.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Karm shareer karta hai — atma to sirf saakshi hai.”***
“The body performs action; the Self is only the witness.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Sun-na, manan karna, aur usi mein nivaas karna.”***
“Listen, reflect deeply, and then dwell continually within the truth.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Jo keval charm, maans aur haddi dekhta hai, woh gyani nahi.”***
“One who sees only skin, flesh, and bone is not truly wise.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

♦ ***“Pahaad ki choti par paani nahi tikta — ahankaari mann mein gyan nahi tikta.”***
“Water does not stay on a mountain peak — knowledge does not stay in an egoistic mind.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Jab tak aatma ka bodh nahi, tab tak yah jeevan bhi ek sapna hai.”***

“Until the Self is realized, even this waking life is only a dream.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Tujhe vishwa is prakar utpann hota hai, jaise samudra se bulbule.”***

“The whole universe rises within you, as bubbles rise from the ocean.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Atma mein vishraam kar, aur swatantra ho kar anand mein vichar.”***

“Rest in the Self, and being inwardly free, move through life in joy.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Jiska is sansar mein kuch hai hi nahi, use chinta kis baat ki?”***

“For one to whom nothing in this world belongs, what is there to worry about?”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

✦ ***“Kahan bandhan, kahan moksha — jahan keval shuddh chaitanya hai.”***

“Where is bondage, where is liberation — where only pure awareness remains?”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

- ♦ ***“Bahar ka maun nahi — mann ka maun chahiye.”***
“Not outer silence — it is the silence of the mind that is needed.”

SAKSHI PATEL INSIGHT

- ♦ ***““Main Shiv hoon” — yah anubhav hai, ahankaar ka daava nahi.”***
““I am Shiva” is a direct realization, not a claim of the ego.”

Glossary



A simple guide to the Sanskrit and Hindi terms used in this book, offered for the newcomer to this path. The definitions are kept short and plain.

Adhyatma — The inner science of the Self; spiritual knowledge concerning the soul and its true nature.

Advaita — Non-duality; the vision that the Self alone is real and all multiplicity is only appearance.

Agya Chakra — The third-eye centre between the eyebrows, the seat of the soul and the focus of meditation.

Ahankara — Ego; the false sense of “I am this body, this position, this status.” The chief obstacle to knowledge.

Aman — The state beyond mental disturbance; the mind grown so still it is almost as if there were no mind.

Amudha — One who is not deluded by sense-objects; the clear-seeing soul, opposite of the mudha.

Atma / Aatma — The soul; a point of pure conscious energy and light. The true Self within every body.

Atma Darshan — Direct realization and experience of oneself as the soul, beyond body, mind, and ego.

Atma Gyan — Knowledge of the soul’s true identity; Self-knowledge.

Atmarama — One who rests and delights in the Self alone, needing nothing outside.

Avinashi — The imperishable; that which can never be destroyed and never disappears from existence.

Behad — Infinite; beyond all limits and boundaries. Used by Bapuji for the boundless dimensions of creation.

Bhavatiti — Beyond feelings and emotions; a state in which the soul transcends all worldly emotional pull.

Brahm / Brahman — The supreme, boundless reality in which the whole of creation appears; the infinite creative ground.

Brahma-jnani — A knower of Brahman; one who has realized the supreme reality.

Chitta — The deep layer of mind that stores impressions; the inner instrument that yoga purifies.

Chitta Shuddhi — Purification of the inner instrument; the cleansing of the deep mind of its impressions.

Dharana — The advanced stage in which long practice transforms the soul's impressions until it becomes the very embodiment of knowledge.

Dharma — Righteousness; the spiritual law of right conduct.

Divya Drishti — Divine vision; the soul's capacity to perceive realities beyond the reach of the outer eyes.

Farishta — An angel-like being; here, a soul that has become light, detached, and above earth-consciousness.

Guru — A spiritual teacher who leads the soul from darkness to light and gives direct Self-knowledge.

Gyan — Knowledge; specifically divine and transcendental knowledge of the Self and reality.

Had / Hud — The limited and finite dimensions of creation; the opposite of behad.

Jivanmukta — One who is liberated while still living in the body.

Jivanmukti — Liberation while living; spiritual freedom attained and enjoyed during one's lifetime.

Karan Sharir — The causal body; the innermost subtle body that stores the soul's karmic record — the "seed" of subtle and physical experience.

Karma — Action, and the energetic imprint left by every thought, word, and deed.

Karma-atita — Beyond the bondage of karma; the state in which action no longer binds the soul.

Kriyavan — That which acts or performs action. The body and senses are kriyavan; the Self is not.

Loka — A world or plane of existence within creation.

Manan — Deep reflection upon a spiritual teaching until every doubt dissolves.

Manorama — One who rests and seeks delight in the restless mind; opposite of Atmarama.

Maya — Illusion; the appearance of reality born of ignorance, removed only by knowledge.

Mithya — That which appears real but is not the ultimate truth; real enough to live in, not real enough to rest upon.

Moksha — Liberation; freedom from all bondage and from the cycle of birth and death.

Mudha — The foolish one, deluded by and attached to sense-objects.

Nididhyasan — Living in continuous awareness of the truth, until it becomes the very ground of one's being.

Nirakar — Formless; without any material shape.

Niranjan — Stainless; untouched by any impurity.

Nirapeksha — Independent and free from expectation.

Nirvikalpa — Beyond all mental alternatives, doubts, and constructions.

Nirvikar — Changeless and without distortion or modification.

Nisanga — Absolute non-attachment; a freedom so complete that the soul leans on nothing.

Nishkama Karma — Selfless, desireless action performed without attachment to its fruit; a purifier of the mind.

Pandit — A learned scholar; one who has memorised much, as distinct from one who has realized the truth.

Param Satya — The supreme truth; the final, unchanging reality.

Paramshanti — Supreme peace; the deepest and most lasting peace of the Self, beyond all worldly calm.

Prarabdha — The portion of past karma that has begun to bear fruit in the present life.

Rajasic — Of the quality of restlessness, desire, and outward activity (rajas).

Sankalpa — A resolve or willed thought; the mind's movement of grasping toward an outcome.

Sanskara — A deep mental impression left by past thoughts and actions, carried across lifetimes.

Satsang — Spiritual company and the gathering for truth; a support for stabilizing knowledge.

Shanta — Peaceful; at perfect rest.

Shravan — Listening to the words of a realized teacher; the first stage of spiritual practice.

Shuddha — Pure; free of every stain and limitation.

Smriti — Remembrance; here, the soul-conscious memory of one's true Self.

Sukshma Sharir — The subtle body; the body of finer elements that holds the soul's desires and operates the physical body.

Tamasic — Of the quality of darkness, inertia, and ignorance (tamas).

Tattva-jnani — A knower of the Self; one who has seen through the elements of existence to the conscious being within.

Tilak — The sacred mark applied between the eyebrows, at the agya chakra, the point of the soul.

Turiya — The “fourth” state of pure awareness, beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep.

Vairagya — Dispassion; the natural falling-away of craving that arises from true knowledge.

Varuna-loka — The realm of Varuna, lord of the waters, referred to in the story of Sage Ashtavakra.

Vedanta — The culminating wisdom of the Vedas, concerned with the knowledge of the Self and Brahman.

Videhi — Beyond body-consciousness; one who lives free of all identification with the body.

Vikalpa — Doubt or mental wavering; the movement of the mind between alternatives.

Vritti — An inner tendency or mental disposition that shapes how one perceives the world.

Yoga — Union; here, the meditative practice that stills the mind and unites the soul with its source.

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Original discourses by Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel

The teachings presented in this book have been drawn directly from the spoken discourses of Bapuji Dashrathbhai Patel. The complete video discourses on which this book is based are available freely on the official YouTube channel.

Readers are warmly encouraged to explore the original discourses for a deeper and more direct understanding. Hearing Bapuji's own voice carries a vibration that no written word can fully convey. The book and the videos are best received together — the book for quiet reflection, the videos for the living transmission.



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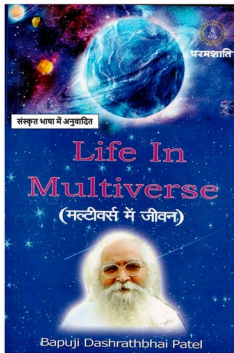
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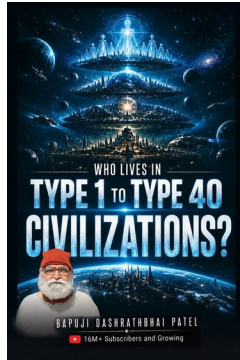


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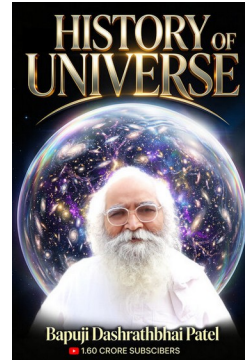
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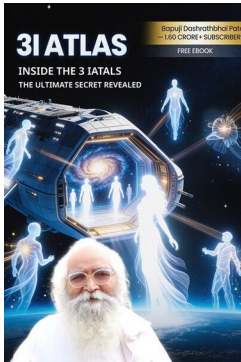
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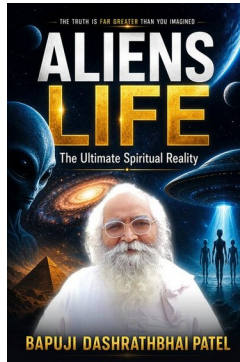
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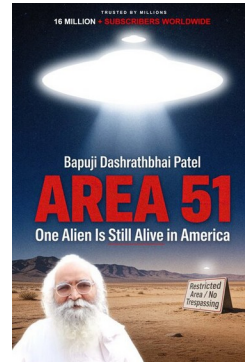
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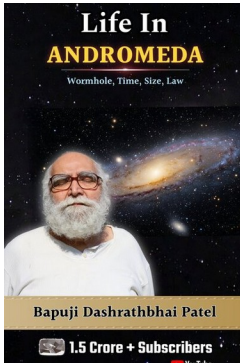


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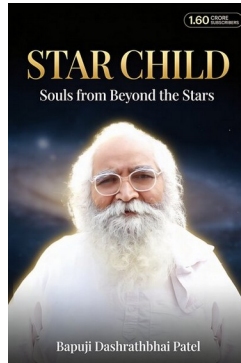


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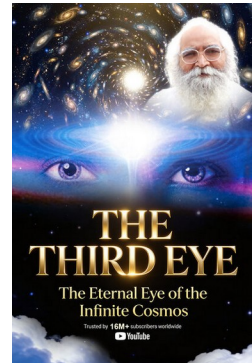
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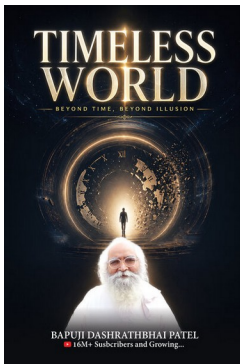
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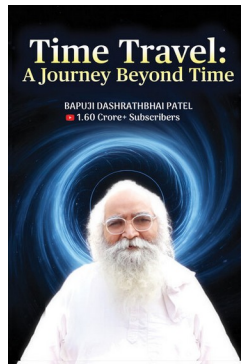
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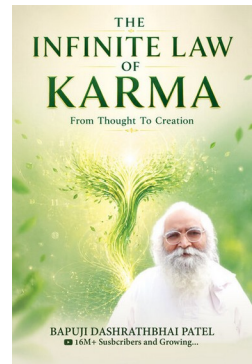
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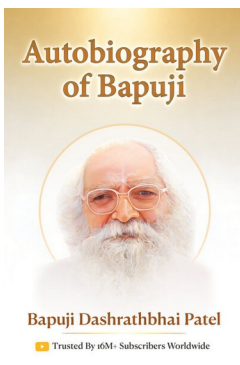


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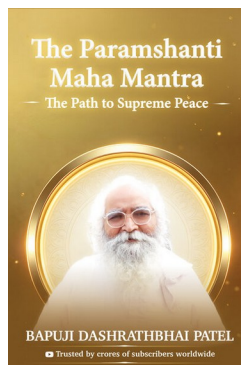


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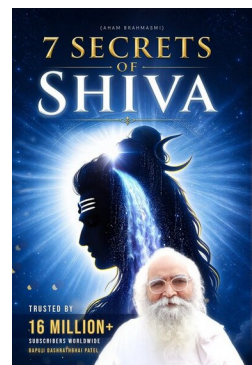
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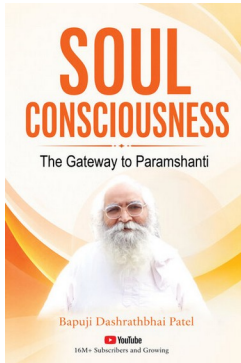
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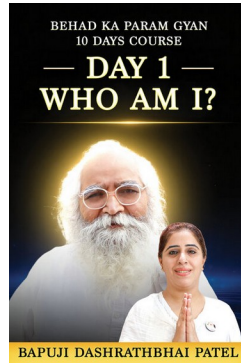
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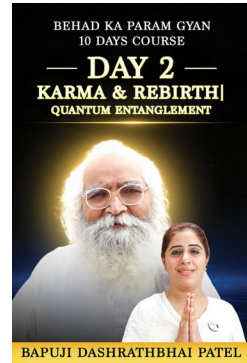
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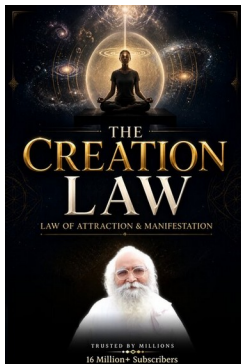
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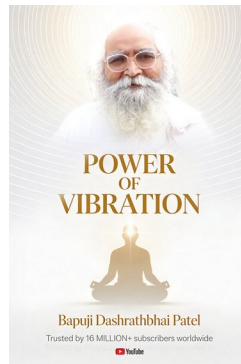
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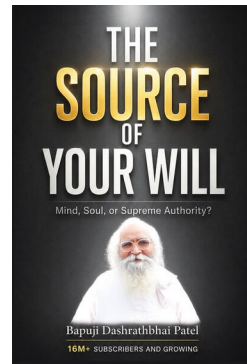
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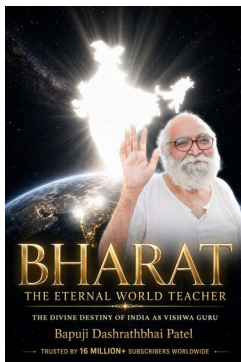
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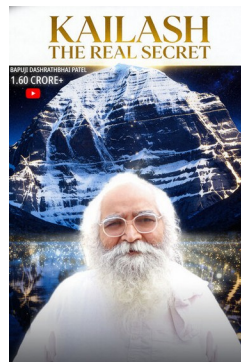
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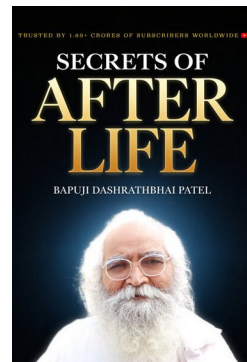
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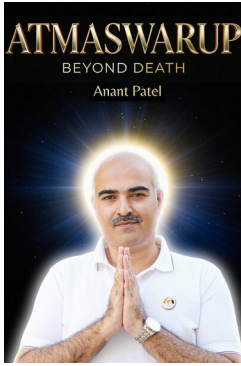
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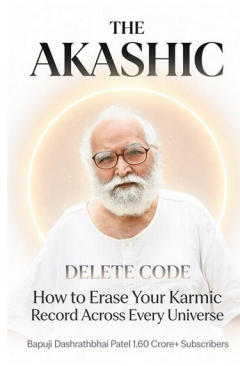
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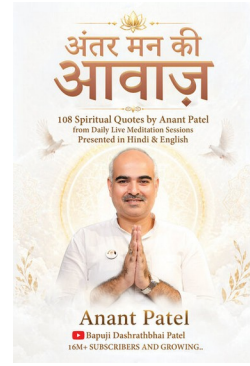
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